FINANCE IN PRACTICE · FREE GUIDE

CFA® Level I *Exam Map*

Where the marks are, how the exam works, and a 12-week route to exam day.

180	2 × 135	300+	43%
multiple-choice questions	minutes, two sessions	study hours reported by passing candidates	pass rate, Aug 2026 (CFA Institute)

Where the marks are



High priority: the heaviest topics. Weights: CFA Institute 2027 topic outline.

> **The five gold topics are about 55–70% of the exam.** Ethics, Quant, FSA, Equities and Fixed Income decide most results. Master them first, then build the rest around them.

Exam windows: Level I runs in February, May, August and November. Check dates and fees at cfainstitute.org.

12-WEEK ROUTE

A plan that follows how topics build on each other

About 25 hours a week. Studying 15 hours a week? Stretch the same order over 20 weeks.

Wk 1–2	**Quantitative Methods + Economics**	The toolkit: time value, statistics, rates.
Wk 3–4	**Financial Statement Analysis**	Biggest reading load. Start early.
Wk 5	**Corporate Finance**	Short; builds on FSA.
Wk 6–7	**Equities**	Valuation models and market structure.
Wk 8–9	**Fixed Income**	Pricing, yield, duration. Practise daily.
Wk 10	**Derivatives + Alternative Investments**	Payoffs and how each asset behaves.
Wk 11	**Portfolio Construction + Ethics**	Ethics last, so it is fresh on exam day.
Wk 12	**Mock exams + review**	Two full mocks. Fix the error pattern, not just the question.

Exam-day rules worth knowing

- **About 90 seconds per question.** Flag anything over two minutes and come back.
- **No penalty for wrong answers.** Never leave a question blank.
- **Formulas are not given.** Know them well enough to rebuild them, not just recite them.
- **Mocks under exam timing** in the last two weeks show your real pace.

Want this plan built around your exam date?

Book a free 30-minute diagnostic session. We find your weak topics and map your route to exam day. At your home in Abu Dhabi or live online.

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